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Modern Russia as semi-peripheral, dependent capitalism

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The main aim of this chapter is to provide an analysis of the nature of modern Russian capitalism from the perspective of how the specific methods of capital accumulation affected state development and evolved over the last 20 years. My approach is based on a reinterpretation of the world system analysis from the perspective of Marxian surplus value theory.

After great enthusiasm and expectations raised 20 years ago by Gorbachev's perestroika, it seems that all parties – both Russians and the West – are severely disillusioned. Russians suffer plummeting living standards and the pitiable condition of the Russian state; the West suffers challenges posed by Putin to some aspects of Western domination in the post-Soviet area.

Marxism and world system analysis

World-System Analysis (WSA) provides a vision of capitalism consistent with so-called 'orthodox Marxism'. Surplus value theory is equally applicable both to national capitalist economies, including theoretically possible closed economies, and to the world system. Marx's *Capital* and the world system approach correlate as the abstract and the concrete. The ascent from abstract to concrete lies at the heart of the Marxian method; and the essence of core–periphery relations, which are at the heart of WSA, could be (and should be) interpreted from labour value and surplus value perspectives. The very nature of the phenomenon of peripheral capitalism lies in the transfer of a significant part of the labour value fund created by the population of a dependent nation, to the core countries. The lack of this